

James Fehlberg

Response to both advertised Key Capabilities

01

Demonstrated teaching competence and capacity to provide leadership that contributes to improved learning outcomes for all students.

I bring current classroom credibility and leadership that already extends beyond my own classes. At Ferny Grove SHS I lead development of Years 7–10 Digital Technologies curriculum and assessment, including ACARA v9-aligned units, assessment frameworks, marking guides and exemplars. I support colleagues and early-career teachers with planning and digital pedagogy and have led whole-staff professional development. This is practical instructional leadership: turning curriculum intent into sequences, resources and assessment processes that teachers can use consistently.

The student impact is in the quality and consistency of what they encounter. Shared sequencing, success criteria and assessment expectations reduce avoidable variation between classes. In my own teaching I use explicit scaffolding, differentiated pathways and project-based learning so students who need more structure can access demanding content while students ready to extend are not held back. My earlier Years 7–9 multi-age teaching required the same discipline: know where a student is, adjust the pathway and keep the learning expectation meaningful. I also coordinate coding and robotics opportunities that give students additional ways to connect with learning.

As YLC, I would apply that same approach at cohort level. Attendance, behaviour, engagement and achievement should not be viewed as separate problems. I would notice patterns early, work with the Year Level Team and help remove barriers that are preventing students from accessing learning. My leadership aim is simple: clearer systems for adults, more consistent expectations for students and earlier support when a student begins to drift.

Teaching + staff leadership ↗

Attendance + early intervention ↗

02

Demonstrated strong interpersonal skills and the capacity to develop and sustain productive relationships within and beyond the school community, including students, families from diverse backgrounds, and community agencies.

My interpersonal approach is built around a principle I use with students: the relationship gives you influence to hold the boundary, so the boundary should stay firm and the relationship should stay intact. During an exam, a student became highly escalated because they wanted computer free time instead of completing the assessment. Rather than argue across the room, I separated the student from the audience, asked them to get a drink and reset, then addressed the behaviour once they were regulated. We clarified the task, the likely time required and what could happen after completion. The student returned and completed the exam. Regulation came first; accountability remained.

The same approach shapes communication with families. I begin with facts, listen before assuming, clarify expectations and move toward the next useful action. I make patterns visible when concerns extend beyond one incident, and I also make positive contact when a student turns a corner. My teaching and youth-work experience has required me to work with families with different needs, circumstances and perspectives. Respectful communication does not mean avoiding a difficult message; it means delivering it in a way that keeps the family able to work with the school.

Before teaching, I supported young people experiencing complex trauma. I used de-escalation and co-regulation, worked from case plans, maintained formal records and collaborated with families, schools, Child Safety and health professionals. That experience taught me when to act directly, when to refer and when coordinated support is the responsible response. Combined with current behaviour investigation, family communication and university liaison, it gives me a strong base for the YLC role as a connector between students, staff, families and external supports.

Student relationship ↗

Family communication ↗

Community agencies ↗